

# Chocolate Sales Performance Analysis

## Excel & Tableau Project

### 1. Project Overview

This project presents a comprehensive sales performance analysis of a global chocolate sales dataset sourced from Kaggle. The objective of the analysis is to transform raw transactional data into actionable business insights using Microsoft Excel for data preparation and Tableau for interactive data visualization and executive reporting.

### 2. Dataset Description

The dataset contains 3,282 sales records with the following fields: Sales Person, Country, Product, Date, Amount, and Boxes Shipped. The data represents chocolate product sales across multiple countries and sales representatives during the year 2022. The dataset was obtained from Kaggle and required preprocessing before analysis.

### 3. Data Cleaning & Preparation (Excel)

Several data quality issues were identified during the initial exploration phase. The Date column contained mixed data types, including text-based dates and Excel serial dates. To resolve this, dates were standardized by reconstructing all date values using Excel date functions, ensuring a consistent DD/MM/YYYY format across the dataset. Additional checks were conducted to validate numeric fields, remove inconsistencies, and confirm the absence of null values in critical columns such as Product, Country, and Amount.

New derived fields were created to support time-series analysis and visualization, including Year, Month, and Month Number. The cleaned dataset was then structured in a tabular format optimized for Tableau integration.

### 4. Visual Analytics & Dashboard Design (Tableau)

Five key visualizations were developed in Tableau to address core business questions and performance metrics:

1. Top Salespersons by Sales Amount – Identifies the highest-performing sales representatives based on total revenue generated.
2. Boxes Shipped per Country – Highlights distribution volume across different markets, supporting logistics and supply chain decisions.
3. High-Revenue Products – Displays products generating the highest sales revenue.
4. Low-Revenue Products – Identifies underperforming products for potential portfolio optimization.
5. Monthly Boxes Shipped Trend – Determines which months experienced the highest shipping volumes, revealing seasonal demand patterns.
6. Most Shipped Products – Analyzes product demand based on shipment volume.

Interactive filters for Country, Product, Sales Person, and Month were incorporated into the dashboard to enable dynamic exploration and user-driven analysis.

## 5. Key Business Insights

The analysis revealed that a small group of sales representatives contributed a significant share of total revenue, indicating strong individual performance concentration. Certain countries demonstrated consistently higher shipment volumes, suggesting mature or high-demand markets. Premium chocolate products generated higher revenue per unit, while some products exhibited high shipment volume but comparatively lower revenue, highlighting opportunities for pricing or cost optimization. Seasonal trends were observed, with shipment volumes peaking in specific months.

## 6. Executive Summary & Recommendations

From an executive perspective, the findings support targeted sales strategy refinement, including incentive alignment for top-performing sales staff, strategic focus on high-revenue products, and data-driven demand planning based on seasonal shipment trends. Underperforming products should be reviewed for repositioning or rationalization. Overall, the project demonstrates how Excel and Tableau can be effectively leveraged to deliver decision-ready insights from raw sales data.

### **Prepared by:**

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